

2007

THE YEAR THAT WAS

RETRO CHIC

Lack of originality or love for the classics? Bollywood raided its past for movies as varied as the full-on entertainer *Om Shanti Om*; *Johnny Gaddar*, which channelled *Parwana*; *Khoya Khoya Chand*, a tribute to Guru Dutt; *Manorama: Six Feet Under*, which doffed its hat to *Chinatown*.

JAIL BAIT

Salman Khan (below right) was jailed in Jodhpur and Sunjay Dutt in Yerawada. Both were out in time to continue their careers.



REEL LIFE

Parzania (below), *Black Friday*, and *Shootout At Lokhandwala* took a leap out of life and faced up to some irresistible truths, be it the riots in Gujarat, violence in Mumbai in 1993 or the underbelly of the big city.



VISIBLE MUSLIMS

Chak de! India's Kabir Khan (below) who was called pro-Pakistani, *Dhoka*'s Sarah who blew herself up over atrocities in Kashmir. *Saawariya*'s Sakina, *Khoya Khoya Chand*'s Nikhat. Muslims came in from the margins.



BORDER MUSIC

Pakistani music was big and the man who understood it best, Pritam, scored some of the biggest hits of the year, from *Life in a ...Metro* (below) to *Awaarapan*.



PHOTO FINISH

Photography became collectible as an overpriced art market made way for a new medium and newer stars.

INTOLERANCE INC

Whether it was M.F. Husain's (below) art or that of the students of MS University, Vadodara, whether it was Shilpa Shetty's kiss or Mallika Sherawat's New Year's dance, the guardians of public morality were in overdrive.

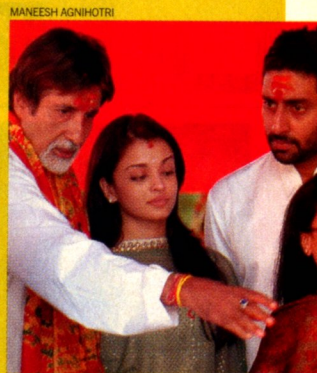


DANCE NATION

Everyone danced, from hockey coaches to television anchors, and *Jhalak Dikhla Jaa* and *Nach Baliye 3* had audiences going, *aa ja nach le*.

BACHCHANALIA

A wedding, a funeral, tax notices, farm ownership, political preoccupation, spats with fellow stars and the ruling dynasty. The Bachchans, all four of them, were the first family of tabloid tattle and news television.



INCONVENIENT WOMEN

Taslima Nasreen was forced out of Kolkata by a government looking to shift focus from Nandigram. Kiran Bedi quit the IPS because of the inability to network like one of the boys.

LAUGH OUT LOUD

Silly and sometimes offensive, but comedies worked at the box office, with movies like *Bheja Fry*, *Heyy Babyy*, *Welcome* and *Partner*.